

Fragment of an Agon

SWEENEY. WAUCHOPE. HORSFALL. KLIPSTEIN.
KRUMPACKER. SWARTS. SNOW. DORIS. DU
STY.

SWEENEY: I'll carry you off
To a cannibal isle.

DORIS: You'll be the cannibal!

SWEENEY: You'll be the missionary!

5 You'll be my little seven stone missionary!
I'll gobble you up. I'll be the cannibal.

DORIS: You'll carry me off? To a cannibal isle?

SWEENEY: I'll be the cannibal.

DORIS: I'll be the missionary.
I'll convert you!

10 SWEENEY: I'll convert *you!*
Into a stew.
A nice little, white little, missionary stew.

DORIS: You wouldn't eat me!

SWEENEY: Yes I'd eat you!
In a nice little, white little, soft little, tender little,
Juicy little, right little, missionary stew.
15 You see this egg
You see this egg

Well that's life on a crocodile isle.
There's no telephones
There's no gramophones
20 There's no motor cars
No two-seaters, no six-seaters,
No Citroën, no Rolls-Royce.
Nothing to eat but the fruit as it grows.
Nothing to see but the palmtrees one way
25 And the sea the other way,
Nothing to hear but the sound of the surf.
Nothing at all but three things
DORIS: What things?
SWEENEY: Birth, and copulation, and death.
That's all, that's all, that's all, that's all,
30 Birth, and copulation, and death.
DORIS: I'd be bored.
SWEENEY: You'd be bored.
Birth, and copulation, and death.
DORIS: I'd be bored.
SWEENEY: You'd be bored.
Birth, and copulation, and death.
35 That's all the facts when you come to brass tacks:
Birth, and copulation, and death.
I've been born, and once is enough.
You don't remember, but I remember,
Once is enough.

SONG BY WAUCHOPE AND HORSFALL
SWARTS AS TAMBO. SNOW AS BONES

40

Under the bamboo
Bamboo bamboo
Under the bamboo tree
Two live as one
One live as two

45

Two live as three
Under the bam
Under the boo
Under the bamboo tree.

50

Where the breadfruit fall
And the penguin call
And the sound is the sound of the sea
Under the bam
Under the boo
Under the bamboo tree.

55

Where the Gauguin maids
In the banyan shades
Wear palmleaf drapery
Under the bam
Under the boo

60

Under the bamboo tree.

Tell me in what part of the wood
Do you want to flirt with me?

Under the breadfruit, banyan, palmleaf
 Or under the bamboo tree?
 65 Any old tree will do for me
 Any old wood is just as good
 Any old isle is just my style
 Any fresh egg
 Any fresh egg
 70 And the sound of the coral sea.

DORIS: I don't like eggs; I never liked eggs;
 And I don't like life on your crocodile isle.

SONG BY KLIPSTEIN AND KRUMPACKER.

SNOW AND SWARTS AS BEFORE

My little island girl
 My little island girl
 75 I'm going to stay with you
 And we won't worry what to do
 We won't have to catch any trains
 And we won't go home when it rains
 We'll gather hibiscus flowers
 80 For it won't be minutes but hours
 For it won't be hours but years

85 *diminuendo* { And the morning
 And the evening
 And noontime
 And night
 Morning
 Evening
 Noontime
 Night

90 DORIS: That's not life, that's no life
Why I'd just as soon be dead.
SWEENEY: That's what life is. Just is
DORIS: What is?
What's that life is?
SWEENEY: Life is death.
I knew a man once did a girl in—
95 DORIS: Oh Mr. Sweeney, please don't talk,
I cut the cards before you came
And I drew the coffin
SWARTS: *You* drew the coffin?
DORIS: I drew the COFFIN very last card.
I don't care for such conversation
100 A woman runs a terrible risk.
SNOW: Let Mr. Sweeney continue his story.
I assure you, Sir, we are very interested.
SWEENEY: I knew a man once did a girl in
Any man might do a girl in
105 Any man has to, needs to, wants to
Once in a lifetime, do a girl in.
Well he kept her there in a bath
With a gallon of lysol in a bath
SWARTS: These fellows always get pinched in the end.
110 SNOW: Excuse me, they don't all get pinched in the end.
What about them bones on Epsom Heath?
I seen that in the papers
You seen it in the papers

They *don't* all get pinched in the end.

115 DORIS: A woman runs a terrible risk.
SNOW: Let Mr. Sweeney continue his story.
SWEENEY: This one didn't get pinched in the end
But that's another story too.
This went on for a couple of months
120 Nobody came
And nobody went
But he took in the milk and he paid the rent.
SWARTS: What did he do?
All that time, what did he do?

125 SWEENEY: What did he do! what did he do?
That don't apply.
Talk to live men about what they do.
He used to come and see me sometimes
I'd give him a drink and cheer him up.
DORIS: Cheer him up?

130 DUSTY: Cheer him up?
SWEENEY: Well here again that don't apply
But I've gotta use words when I talk to you.
But here's what I was going to say.
He didn't know if he was alive
and the girl was dead
He didn't know if the girl was alive
135 and he was dead
He didn't know if they both were alive
or both were dead

If he was alive then the milkman wasn't
and the rent-collector wasn't
And if they were alive then he was dead.
There wasn't any joint
140 There wasn't any joint
For when you're alone
When you're alone like he was alone
You're either or neither
I tell you again it don't apply
145 Death or life or life or death
Death is life and life is death
I gotta use words when I talk to you
But if you understand or if you don't
That's nothing to me and nothing to you
150 We all gotta do what we gotta do
We're gona sit here and drink this booze
We're gona sit here and have a tune
We're gona stay and we're gona go
And somebody's gotta pay the rent

DORIS: I know who

155 SWEENEY: But that's nothing to me and nothing to you.

FULL CHORUS: WAUCHOPE, HORSFALL, KLIPSTEIN, KRUMPACKER

When you're alone in the middle of the night and
you wake in a sweat and a hell of a fright
When you're alone in the middle of the bed and
you wake like someone hit you on the head
You've had a cream of a nightmare dream and
you've got the hoo-ha's coming to you.

Hoo hoo hoo

160 You dreamt you waked up at seven o'clock and it's
foggy and it's damp and it's dawn and it's dark
And you wait for a knock and the turning of a lock
for you know the hangman's waiting for you.

And perhaps you're alive

And perhaps you're dead

Hoo ha ha

165 Hoo ha ha

Hoo

Hoo

Hoo

KNOCK KNOCK KNOCK

170 KNOCK KNOCK KNOCK

KNOCK

KNOCK

KNOCK